

Environmental Services

First Lithium Project in Mali – Goulamina Project

The Applicant

Timbuktu Ressources S.A.R.L. (Timbuktu), a company incorporated under Malian law and a subsidiary of Mali Lithium, formerly Birimian Limited, (ASX:BGS/MLL) is an Australian based company.

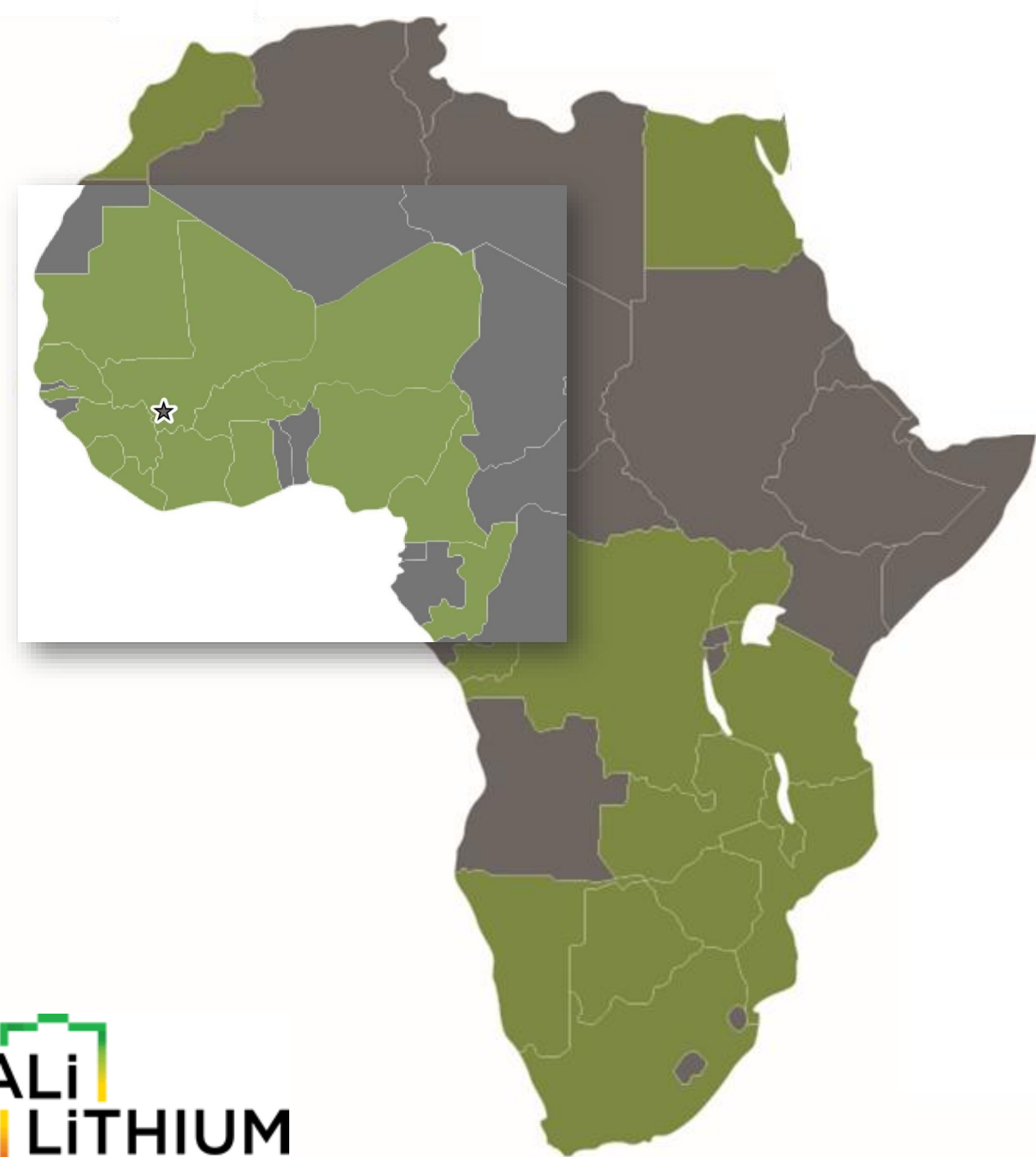
Mali Lithium's focus is on the development of the Goulamina Project, and also holds prospective gold projects in southern Mali.

World Class Lithium Deposit

This mine is referred to as the Goulamina Lithium Project.

Located in Southern Mali, approximately 150 km south of the country's capital of Bamako, the Goulamina project is host to highly prospective lithium pegmatites. Goulamina is the largest uncommitted hard rock lithium mineral reserve in the world, with an estimated 31.2 million tonnes.

Timbuktu intends to exploit the lithium pegmatite through the construction of an open pit lithium mine and processing plant, with an initial Life of Mine (LoM) of a minimum of 16 years.



Project Progress to Date

In March 2019, the Environmental Permit was issued by the Ministère De l'Environnement. ***The Goulamina Project was the first authorized lithium project in Mali.***

The Environmental Permit, and subsequent Exploitation Permit, was a consequence of several years of exploration, feasibility studies and environmental and social specialist studies.

Digby Wells Role



Digby Wells Environmental (Digby Wells) was appointed to undertake a preliminary Environmental and Social screening assessment in 2016. The objectives of the screening assessment were to determine:

- High-level baseline characteristics;
- Potential fatal flaw and project risks; and to
- Determine the terms of reference for the Environmental and Social Impact Assessment (ESIA).

The findings of the screening assessment fed into the Project's Scoping Study. Digby Wells was subsequently appointed to undertake the ESIA process in February 2017, as part of the feasibility studies for the Goulamina Project.

Digby Wells' multidisciplinary team of in-house, integrated specialists completed the following studies in support of the ESIA:

- Air Quality Assessment
- Fauna and Flora Assessment
- Geochemistry
- Surface Water Assessment
- Groundwater Assessment
- Heritage Impact Assessment
- Noise Impact Assessment
- Social Impact Assessment (SIA)
- Soils Impact Assessment
- Visual Impact Assessment
- Wetland Impact Assessment
- Closure & Rehabilitation

All environmental and social studies for the proposed Goulamina Project were undertaken in accordance to:

- Malian legislation;
- The frameworks provided in the Equator Principles;
- The World Bank Group; and International Finance Corporation (IFC) policies and guidelines



The SIA included the socio-economic baseline profile of communities and the socio-economic impacts that may occur due to the proposed Project, and proposed management.

Mali Lithium appointed Digby Wells to undertake a Community Development Plan (CDP). Focus Group Discussions (FGDs) and key informant interviews, as well as household socio-economic studies were undertaken to acquire an understanding of the living conditions, demographics, livelihoods, access to infrastructure and service and developmental needs.

These findings fed into a short, medium and long-term development plan linked to mine production which ensures that the local communities benefit from the mine through sustainable projects.

The CDP was approved by the authorities in conjunction with the Exploitation Permit

Project Innovation – A First of it's kind

Mali has a proud history of gold mining, and is the 3rd largest producer of Gold in Africa (WGC 2018).

Despite Mali's history in Gold mining, Lithium and Spodumene was a new commodity and process for the mining and environmental authorities. Digby Wells took on the responsibility of ensuring that the authorities understood and recognized the impacts associated with Lithium Mining.

Following the submission of the reports, the authorities made it clear of their intention to use this report as a benchmark for future lithium projects in the country.



The next steps

Mali Lithium is mapping its path to production to capitalise on forecast rising demand for lithium driven by the growth in electric vehicle demand.

Next steps include:

- Completion of a Bankable Feasibility Study and optimisation studies;
- Securing binding offtake agreements;
- Securing project financing;
- Front End Engineering and Design (FEED), followed by detailed design work;
- Procurement and ordering of long lead-time items; and
- Construction, commissioning and production ramp-up.

Message from the Project Manager



Duncan Pettit
Senior Environmental Consultant

Given the project location it was not only important that the authorities understood lithium mining, but also that the communities understood the impacts of mining, both positive and negative.

The transparent SEP was warmly received which contributed to a thorough project planning and feasibility process.